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SECURITY



Hackers stole Social Security numbers during Allianz Life cyberattack



Hackers who breached U.S. insurance giant Allianz Life earlier this month stole reams of customer Social Security numbers, according to notifications filed with several U.S. states and seen by TechCrunch.

Allianz Life disclosed [the July 16 breach this past weekend](#), confirming to TechCrunch the unidentified hackers stole the personally identifiable information belonging to the “majority” of its 14 million customers, as well as financial professionals and some Allianz Life employees.

The company said its customer relationship database was compromised in a [social engineering attack](#), a ploy in which malicious hackers use deception tricks, such as impersonating an employee claiming to have lost their password, to convince helpdesks into granting them access to a system or network.

In a [new filing](#) with the Texas attorney general, Allianz Life said the hackers stole names, dates of birth, postal addresses, and Social Security numbers from its database. A [separate filing](#) with the Massachusetts attorney general’s office also confirmed Social Security numbers were taken in the breach.

When reached by email, Allianz Life spokesperson Brett Weinberg said that the company is aware of the types of personal data that was stolen in the

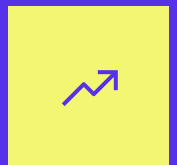
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breach, but declined to share this information with TechCrunch.

The spokesperson said Allianz Life is expected to begin notifying affected individuals by August 1.

“The letters will offer specific information relevant to impacted individuals including the type of data that may have been affected,” the spokesperson added.

Allianz Life is the latest insurance company, including [Aflac](#) and [Erie](#), in recent weeks to have been breached, as [multiple hacking groups](#) known for social engineering attacks ramp up their cyberattacks.

Do you know more about the Allianz Life cyberattack? Are you an affected customer or employee? Securely contact this reporter via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337](#) on Signal.

Updated with additional comment from Allianz Life.

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SECURITY



Allianz Life says ‘majority’ of customers’ personal data stolen in cyberattack

Zack Whittaker — 6:40 AM PDT · July 26, 2025

U.S. insurance giant Allianz Life has confirmed to TechCrunch that hackers stole the personal information of the “majority” of its customers, financial professionals, and employees during a mid-July data breach.

When reached by TechCrunch, Allianz Life spokesperson Brett Weinberg confirmed the breach.

“On July 16, 2025, a malicious threat actor gained access to a third-party, cloud-based CRM system used by Allianz Life,” referring to a customer relationship management (CRM) database

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containing information on its customers. “The threat actor was able to obtain personally identifiable data related to the majority of Allianz Life’s customers, financial professionals, and select Allianz Life employees, using a social engineering technique,” the spokesperson said.

The company disclosed the data breach on Saturday in a [legally required filing](#) with Maine’s attorney general but did not immediately provide a number of how many Allianz Life customers are affected. According to the spokesperson, Allianz Life has 1.4 million customers. Its parent company, Allianz, has more than 125 million customers worldwide.

Allianz Life said it notified the FBI and added it had “no evidence” that any other systems on its network were compromised.

The insurance giant would not say if it had received any communication from the hackers, such as a ransom note. The company also would not attribute the breach to a hacking group.

Allianz Life is the latest company in the past month to have been hacked during a wave of data breaches targeting the wider insurance industry, [including Aflac](#), a major provider of supplementary health insurance. Security researchers at Google said in June that [they were “aware of multiple intrusions” across the insurance sector](#) attributed to Scattered Spider, a collective of hackers and techniques that rely on social engineering methods, such as deceptively calling and tricking help desks into granting them access to a company’s network.

Prior to targeting insurance companies, the Scattered Spider hackers were seen [targeting the U.K. retail industry](#), as well as the [aviation and](#)

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[transportation sectors](#), and are historically known for hacks [targeting Silicon Valley technology giants](#).

Per the Maine filing, Allianz plans to begin notifying affected individuals around August 1.

Do you know more about the Allianz Life cyberattack? Are you an affected customer or employee? Securely contact this reporter via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337](#) on Signal.

Topics: [cyberattack](#) [cybersecurity](#) [data breach](#)

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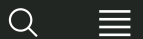




US insurance giant Aflac says customers' personal data stolen during cyberattack

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US insurance giant Aflac informed Monday in a [legally required filing](#) with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission that the company identified hackers in its system on June 12 and contained the incident. Aflac, which provides supplemental insurance to individuals whose expenses are not covered by their primary providers, said it was not yet known how many customers are affected by the data breach but that the personal data includes customers' claims, such as Social Security numbers and health information.

The breach also included data from Aflac's beneficiaries, employees, and agents, the company said.

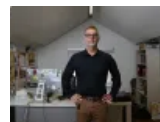
Aflac said its systems were not affected by ransomware, but attributed the breach to an



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Amanda Silberling,
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- 11 hours ago

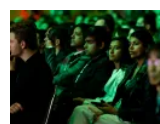
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Citizen Lab director warns cyber industry about US authoritarian descent

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai
- 16 hours ago

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unspecified cybercrime group known to be targeting the U.S. insurance industry. According to [its Friday press release](#), Aflac said the hackers used social engineering tactics to break into its network.

An Aflac spokesperson, who did not provide their name, declined to answer TechCrunch's questions when reached by email on Monday.

Aflac, which has around 50 million customers per [the company's website](#), is the latest U.S. insurance company to experience a cyberattack in recent weeks, amid warnings that hackers are targeting the wider insurance industry.

John Hultquist, the chief analyst for Google's threat intelligence unit, said last week that the unit was "aware of multiple intrusions" in the U.S. that bear the hallmarks of activity linked to Scattered Spider, a loose-knit collective of hackers and tactics that rely on [social engineering](#) tactics and sometimes threats of violence to target company help desks and call centers in order to gain access to their networks.

The hackers are also [reportedly behind](#) the recent intrusions at [Erie Insurance](#) and [Philadelphia Insurance Companies](#), which disclosed cyberattacks this month, with disruption ongoing.

The hackers linked to Scattered Spider attacks are known to be financially motivated and have been previously linked to cyberattacks and intrusions at [tech giants](#), [casinos, and hotels](#), and [recent data breaches](#) across the U.K. and U.S. retail sector.

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23andMe admits it didn't detect cyberattacks for months

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

— 12:21 PM PST · January 25, 2024

In a data breach notification letter filed with regulators this weekend, 23andMe revealed that hackers started breaking into customers' accounts in April 2023 and continued through most of September.

In other words, for around five months, 23andMe did not detect a series of cyberattacks where hackers were trying — and often succeeding — in brute-forcing access to customers' accounts, [according to a legally required filing 23andMe sent to California's attorney general.](#)

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Months after the hackers started targeting 23andMe customers, the company revealed that [hackers had stolen the ancestry and genetic data of 6.9 million users](#), or about half of its customers.

According to the company, 23andMe became aware of the breach in October when [hackers advertised the stolen data](#) in posts published on the unofficial 23andMe subreddit and separately on a notorious hacking forum. 23andMe also did not notice that the hackers advertised the stolen data on another hacking forum months earlier in August, [as TechCrunch reported](#).

Contact Us

Do you have more information about this hack? We'd love to hear from you. From a non-work device, you can contact Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai securely on Signal at +1 917 257 1382, or via Telegram, Keybase and Wire @lorenzofb, or email lorenzo@techcrunch.com. You also can contact TechCrunch via [SecureDrop](#).

[As 23andMe later admitted](#), hackers were able to access the accounts of around 14,000 customers by brute-forcing into accounts that were using passwords already made public and associated with email addresses from other breaches. With access to those accounts, the hackers stole data on 6.9 million customers by way of the [DNA Relatives](#) feature, which lets customers automatically share some of their data with others that 23andMe classifies as relatives. The stolen data included the person's name, birth year, relationship labels, the percentage of DNA shared with relatives, ancestry reports and self-reported location.

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23andMe spokespeople did not immediately respond to TechCrunch's request for comment, which included questions about how the breach went undetected for so long.

After customers were notified that they were victims of the breach, several victims have filed class action lawsuits against 23andMe in the U.S. and Canada, even though [the company tried to make it harder for victims to band together in legal actions by changing its terms of service](#). Data breach lawyers called the terms of service changes "cynical," "self-serving," and "a desperate attempt" to protect 23andMe against its own customers.

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In one of the lawsuits, 23andMe responded by [blaming users](#) for allegedly using reused passwords.

“Users negligently recycled and failed to update their passwords following these past security incidents, which are unrelated to 23andMe,” [23andMe claimed in a letter to breach victims](#). “The incident was not a result of 23andMe’s alleged failure to maintain reasonable security measures.”

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Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai

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Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai is a Senior Writer at TechCrunch, where he covers hacking, cybersecurity,...

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